# Gowrish Kumar Reddy

Chennai, India

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Mechanistic Interpretability · AI Alignment & Safety · LLM Evaluation · Multi-Agent Safety

## EDUCATION

**SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Ramapuram** — *Chennai, India*

*B.Tech, Computer Science & Engineering (AI & Machine Learning)* — CGPA 8.7 / 10.0 · Expected May 2028

## RESEARCH PROJECTS

**Collusion Monitors in Agent Swarms (Apart Research Swarm Alignment Hackathon, solo)** — Nov 2026

*Python · Ollama · small open-weight LLMs · AI Village agent logs*

- Tested five behaviour-based collusion monitors on 227 repeated-pricing games of small LLMs in swarms of 4 to 12 agents.
- Found monitors accused innocent same-model pairs 4–16× as often as mixed pairs; false-accusation games rose from 60% to 100% as swarms grew.
- Calibration on known-innocent pairs or label-free twin replays cut false accusations to 15–50%; on real AI Village logs, a label-free control removed a timing-only same-model signal (13 of 22 pairs flagged).

**Station House, open-source research contributor** — Oct 2026 – present

*Python · Inspect AI · Hugging Face*

- ConspiracyBench: 41 merged PRs. Stress-tested the Inspect evaluation pipeline (incomplete transcripts, retries and timeouts, malformed input, a Windows encoding fix); added 35 sourced questions in six languages.
- Found that a small local LLM judge could be flipped by a reply imitating a grader note (exploratory, n=1 per case).
- Marin 32B neuron hunt (with SAAR India): explaining MLP neurons from exemplars and the logit lens; first one in draft.

**Detecting Collusion in LLM Agents (Apart Research AI Collusion Sprint, solo)** — Oct 2026

*Python · open-weight LLMs · statistical calibration*

- Tested whether pairwise net influence (Bonjour et al., 2022) detects collusion among LLM agents in repeated three-player rock-paper-scissors; ran 64 games on Qwen3-8B, Llama 3.1 8B and gpt-oss-20b.
- Found it blind when teammates collapse to one move, and found it falsely accused the two same-model players in 4 of 5 mixed-model games; a same-model leave-one-out calibration cut false accusations from 38% to 6%.
- Reported small samples and post hoc labels as limitations. Paper and public code submitted; judging pending.

**GPT-2 Mechanistic Interpretability Pipeline** — 2026

*Python · PyTorch*

- Built a GPT-2 forward pass from scratch with per-head hooks; it matches HuggingFace's logits within 2e-4 and, on real GPT-2 Medium, finds induction heads (L9H9, 0.95) and previous-token heads (L5H11, 0.97).
- Zeroing the top five cut P(correct repeated token) from 0.88 to 0.78. Validated first on synthetic weights with planted circuits.

**CPU-Only VQA Benchmark for Lightweight Vision-Language Models** — 2026

*Python · PyTorch · HuggingFace Transformers · Matplotlib*

- Benchmarked three sub-2B-parameter VLMs (SmolVLM-500M, Moondream2-1.8B, TinyLLaVA-1.4B) on a stratified 1,013-question VQAv2 subset under CPU-only, 8GB-RAM constraints; reported accuracy, latency, peak RAM, load time and throughput.
- Found, with a chi-square test ($p < 0.000001$), a consistent accuracy drop on numeric questions across all three models; validated pairwise comparisons with McNemar's exact test over 3,000+ predictions.
- Built a resumable pipeline with automatic checkpointing for multi-day laptop runs. Manuscript in preparation for a Scopus-indexed venue.

**DistilBERT Sentiment Classifier** — 2026

- Fine-tuned DistilBERT-base on SST-2 (AdamW, cosine LR decay) to 89% test accuracy with a hand-written training loop. Also implemented backpropagation from scratch in NumPy.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|---|---|
| **Languages** | Python, C |
| **ML / DL** | PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, scikit-learn |
| **Research** | LLM evaluation (Inspect AI), activation patching, causal intervention, statistical testing |
| **Tools** | Git, GitHub, Linux, Jupyter, LaTeX, TransformerLens |

## RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Machine Learning · Deep Learning · Linear Algebra · Probability & Statistics · Data Structures & Algorithms · Natural Language Processing